

Cyber Acoustics Portable Amplified Speakers CA-MP30

This device integrates two speakers and a woofer into one small casing that can be carried wherever you go. Its face incorporates circular speaker grills on either side of a 2-inch woofer, along with a power switch, volume control and a tiny reflex port for the woofer. You can power these speakers with the bundled power adaptor, or four AA batteries. Ideal for presentations on notebooks; you can also use the speaker set with portable music players such as cassette players, MP3 players and FM radios.

Tested with a Wipro 1000D notebook, the sound output is decent enough, but not meant for audiophiles.

Company **Arc-Max Technology Company**
Price **Rs 2,500**
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Rating 



Toshiba e400 Pocket PC

Slim And Sleek

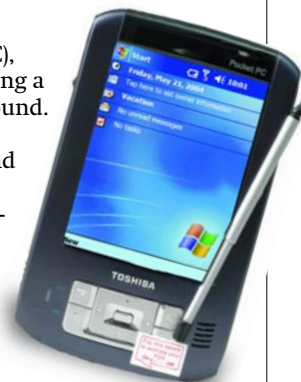
Toshiba's new e400, an entry-level Pocket PC (PPC), looks stunning in its cobalt blue outfit. Measuring a mere 0.4 inch in thickness, this is the slimmest around.

The e400 is driven by Intel's PXA261 300 MHz processor, has 64 MB of RAM and 16 MB of ROM, and comes with a 65K colour transreflective screen, which has a resolution of 320x240. A 980 mAh non-user replaceable battery provides enough juice to power the PPC for 3.5 hours of continuous multimedia usage. An SD slot, and the infrared and USB interfaces complete the memory and data connectivity options.

A bulky power adaptor, USB cable and manuals are bundled. The CD-ROM bundles MS Outlook 2002 and MS Active Sync 3.7, Toshiba also includes a text-to-speech and voice-commanding application. Sensibly priced at Rs 19,500, the Toshiba e400 should fit most pockets.

Company **Esource Global**
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Rating 



New & Notable

O2 Xda II

A Phone In Your Handheld

The O2 Xda II is finally here in India! The much awaited successor to the original Xda smoothens out most of the chinks in its predecessor.

With triband GSM and GPRS capabilities, the Xda II measures 69.9 x 130 x 19 mm³ and weighs 190 gms. There is no unwieldy external antenna, making it quite pocketable. The front facia boasts of a 240 x 320 pixel, 65K colour, transreflective screen with two buttons to access calendar and contacts, and a five-way navigation button flanked by a 'send' and an 'end' call button at the bottom. Two LEDs placed at the top indicate Bluetooth and GSM connectivity, as well as battery charging status, new messages or missed calls.

Powered by an Intel XScale 400 MHz processor, it has 128 MB of RAM and 14 MB of flash ROM storage—enough horsepower to run most of the supported applications, games and play movies. Add more memory or additional functionality such as WiFi via the SDIO slot. Inbuilt Bluetooth connectivity lets you pair the device seamlessly with compatible devices. However, the lack of the OBEX file transfer profile makes it incapable of exchanging files directly using Bluetooth.

Running Windows Mobile 2003 for Pocket PC, the bundled software includes Pocket versions of Outlook, Word, Windows Media Player, Internet Explorer, Microsoft Reader, MMS, Photo Caller ID, PPT and PDF Viewers,

and XBackup. You can synchronise the device with a PC using the bundled ActiveSync 3.7 application and the USB cradle.

The inbuilt digital camera captures stills at a maximum resolution of 480x640 pixels and video at 240x320 pixels. The images captured are not that great though, and turn out grainy. The Photo Contacts application lets you assign images to contacts, thus enabling the photo-caller ID feature.

Calls come through clearly even at locations with low network coverage. If needed, press and hold down the green send button to activate the speakerphone.

Apart from the detailed user manual and software CD, the package includes a stereo headset, a spare stylus, a power adaptor, a leather carry case and a USB cradle that has an extra slot for charging a spare battery. You can also charge the unit directly by using the power adaptor and a bundled converter, so you don't need to lug around the cradle everywhere you go. The user-replaceable 1200 mAh Li-ion Polymer battery lasts just over 4 hours while playing MP3 music at full blast with the backlight set to half its intensity.

A top-notch performance (with features to boot) make the Xda II ideal for the global traveller who wishes to stay connected while on the move.

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Rating 